that emanated from him. In the process did we become participants rather than disconnected observers? Perhaps the media did become part of the Modi propaganda machine, the camera transfixed by the unfailingly sharply dressed PM candidate (apparently, he did not repeat an outfit through the campaign), who seemed to dash between multiple locations with not a hair out of place.

There was no denying the massive viewer interest every time Modi was on air, the sheer size of the rallies, the social media popularity of Modi which became a crucial guide to TV coverage, or the cascading effect of every outlet beaming out Modi, thus perhaps creating a self-perpetuating cycle of constant coverage. The TV camera, I have always believed, is an amoral technology—it covers both good and bad, and it simply goes where the action is. Nirbhaya protests or Ramdev's rallies, Anna Hazare's or Kejriwal's dharnas, in the 24/7 cycle, the camera is invariably drawn to the maximum possible action. Modi was the man who created the action, and inevitably the camera became his constant companion.

In the final analysis, neither sanctimoniousness or self-flagellation is necessary. To suggest the media 'created' the Modi wave is to give ourselves undeserved self-importance. And it is also disrespectful to the mandate given to Modi by millions of Indians who have reposed faith in him. At the Mumbai Press Club debate, ad whizz Piyush Pandey got it right —'Media didn't create the wave, it simply rode on it.'